Twenty - Ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 18th October 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: Monday, Tuesday, and Thursday at 10am.
St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Anniversary Mass -
Anniversary Mass: For Josephine O'Kane on Sunday 25th October at 10am.
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St. Joseph's Church - (Vigil) - Anniversary Mass: For Una Proctor on Saturday 17th October at 6pm.
Anniversary Mass: For James McNicholl on Sunday 18th October at 11.30am.

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Joseph's Church in October.
Eucharistic Adoration: - Adoration on Monday after morning Mass.
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Errigal Parish Mission
Tuesday 27th October until Monday 2nd November.
We hope you will be able to join us for what promises to be a special week of prayer, reflection and renewal for our parish community.

100 Years of World Mission Sunday: 'One in Christ united in Mission'. World Mission Sunday is the Holy Father's annual worldwide celebration of prayer, solidarity and support for the Church's missionary life. It invites Catholics everywhere to participate in the Church's global mission, through prayer and financial support for mission dioceses most in need. The day reminds Catholics that the Church is missionary by nature. Mission is not limited to priests, religious, sisters, or missionaries serving abroad. Every baptised person shares responsibility for proclaiming the Gospel and supporting the growth of the Church throughout the world.

Parish Pastoral Group: The next meeting of the Parish Pastoral Group (to prepare for the Mission) will take place in the Parochial House on Tuesday 20th October at 7.30pm.

Errigal Youth Group: Parish Gift (Growing in Faith Together) - Grow closer to God, connect with friends, get involved in your community and discover your gifts! Saturdays directly after the Vigil Mass in October and November in Glenullin GAC (small hall) (October) Ballerin Errigal Hall (November). Registration available in QR code available in community apps.

Confirmation Candidates Gathering Dates: The autumn gathering of the Confirmation classes (P7's) from both local schools will take place on -

Tuesday 3rd November - (St. Mary's Church/Errigal Hall)

Tuesday 24th November (Provisional Date) - (Glenullin Community Centre).

Each evening from 7pm - 8.30pm. Parental consent forms will be required for those who gather it will be obtained via each school.

Baptism: We welcome into the Christian community Casey James Quinn, 4b Carnaman Road, Gulladuff who was baptised last weekend.

Baptism Dates: The next Baptism dates are Saturday 7th November in St. Mary's Church at 5pm and St. Joseph's Church on Sunday 8th November at 12.30pm. The Baptismal Programme for parents/guardians will take place in the Parochial House on Wednesday 4th November at 7pm. Please register to attend the Baptismal Programme by Friday 30th October using the parish email address, this will indicate to the Baptismal Team the numbers who will attend the Baptismal Programme.

Parish Safeguarding: Vetting process will take place on the first Saturday of every month **after** the Vigil Mass. This will be to re-vet all existing volunteers as a new requirement from the Diocese. If you are over 18 and volunteer as a Sacristan /Choir leader /Children's Liturgy helper or Baptism Group helper for the parish please attend a meeting, on Saturday 7th November in Ballerin Parochial House 6:45pm-7:45pm, at your convenience. Please bring 3 forms of ID with you to the meeting for verification purposes. These will be scanned for parish records.

NB: Most of the Youth ministry volunteers have been recently vetted and therefore do not need to attend.

What is university actually for? Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy is delighted to welcome Dr Paul Shrimpton, writer, historian and scholar of St John Henry Newman, for a public lecture exploring Newman's vision of human flourishing at university - and what it might still have to say to universities and society today. Monday 12th October at 7pm. Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy, 30–38 Elmwood Avenue, Belfast Students, staff, alumni and friends are warmly welcome. Admission free.

Mass Cards (pre-signed): Signed Mass cards for all occasions are available in the side porch of St. Mary's Church as requested by parishioners. A suggested donation of £5 is requested with the name of the recipient in a brown envelope included. Please put the brown envelope in the St.Vincent dePaul box, where it will be retrieved and the monies and Mass intention will be offered locally or by another priest.

Sacrament of Reconciliation: Sacrament of Reconciliation (Confession) available after the Vigil Mass on request.

Errigal SVP: Could You Spare a Little Time to Help Others? As we prepare to celebrate the Feast of St Vincent de Paul (27th September), the Errigal St Vincent de Paul (SVP) Conference need a couple of volunteers to join our local team. This is a wonderful opportunity to put your faith into action, give something back to our community, and make a real difference to the lives of local individuals and families who are struggling.
No previous experience is necessary. You will be warmly welcomed and fully supported by our local SVP Volunteers, with guidance and training provided.
If you would like to find out more, please contact us on 07563595868. We'd be delighted to hear from you. For more details, please see https://www.svp.ie/northern-ireland/

Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell **Trócaire's Gifts of Change** - meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part - and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call 028 9080 8030.

Errigal: Through Our Eyes - Summer Youth Photography Project: Starting Monday 6th July, all young people under 18 are invited to join Errigal: Through Our Eyes, a summer photography project. The theme is "See what matters. See where God is." This will celebrate the beauty, faith, kindness, and everyday life of our parish.
Pick up an entry form, then send up to three photos taken within the parish boundaries and a short reflection to the parish email (with parent/guardian consent for under-16s). There are 1st, 2nd and 3rd place prizes in both Primary and Secondary categories, with certificates for everyone. **Update Deadline - Please note that the closing date for entries has been postponed until the end of September. We warmly encourage all our young people to take part and share their photographs and reflections. More details will follow soon.**

Gift Aid/Census Cards: Can we please request the return of Gift Aid and Census cards recently circulated so that parish records can be updated during the summer months.

Rosary and Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament: Will continue the first Monday of each month. St. Joseph's Church - 7.30pm.

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 183 boxes of envelopes in circulation.
Returns (Pink/Yellow - 91 White - 73)
St. Mary's - Parish: £300 Renovation: £205
St. Joseph's - Parish: £430 Renovation: £500

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 8, 10, 19, 20. Jackpot is £4000. Lucky Dip Winner £50 - Ciara Deighan.
Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 10, 13, 15, and 29. Jackpot £10.000. £25 winners - Majella McCloskey, Barry McLaughlin, Brian McNulty, Denise McCloskey, and Mary Conway.

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Mary's Church - Church Readers - 24th/25th October
Saturday Vigil -
Sunday Morning - Paul Mullan.
If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please gave your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.
Eucharistic Ministers - 24th/25th October
Saturday Vigil -
Sunday Morning - Amanda Mooney & Lee Ann McKay.
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Readers & Eucharistic Ministers
St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 24th/25th October
Saturday Vigil - Gerard O'Kane.
Sunday Morning - Michael Leadon.
If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please gave your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead Mc Nicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.
Eucharistic Ministers - 24th/25th October
Saturday Vigil - Diane Burns & Joanne Heaney.
Sunday Morning - Ráichéal Mhic Noicaill & Margaret Rose Hasson.

Feasts during the Week: Monday - St. Paul of the Cross (1694 - 1775): He founded the Passionists in Rome, preaching on the Passion of Christ and tending the sick, the dying and the lapsed. **Thursday - St. John Paul II:** Was pope for over twenty-six years from the 22nd October 1978, the inauguration of his ministry as universal Pastor of the Church, until his death on 2nd April 2005. Ordained Bishop of Krakow in 1958 and took a significant part in the Second Vatican Council. As Bishop of Rome he visited almost all of the Roman parishes and made apostolic journeys to 104 countries**,** including Ireland, 29th September - 2nd October 1979. (also) **St Canice:** Was born in Co. Derry around 527 and died in 603. Though his people were poor, he studied at Clonard under Finnian and at Glasnevin under Mobhi. A deep friendship developed between himself and Colmcille, with whom he worked for a time in Scotland, where he set up a number of churches. In Ireland his principal foundation was in Ashaboe in Ossory, but this was replaced centuries later by his church in Kilkenny. **Friday - St John of Capistrano (1386 - 1456):** Studied civil and canon law and joined the Franciscan Order. A faithful servant of four popes, he attended the Council of Florence, went to Jerusalem as apostolic emissary, and in 1451, set out on a preaching tour through the German provinces and Poland. In a battle at Belgrade he contracted fever and died there. Patron of jurists and military chaplains. **Saturday - St. Anthony Mary Claret (1807 - 1870):** He founded the Claretians in Spain for missionary work. Archbishop of Santiago, Cuba then returned as chaplain to the Queen of Spain, and built schools and museums, before being exiled with the monarchy.

Diocesan Vocations: St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God

loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction." For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - **'The Word of the Lord'** as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

Look out Leaflets...Are now available for children at the back of both churches in the parish focusing on the liturgy of the word each week. Enjoy!

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at: https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray.

Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters'* - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titles Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

St. Joseph's Church - A YouTube camera link is now available for services from St. Joseph's Church, Glenullin. The link can be accessed - **https://youtube.com**@parishoferrigalderry.

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Prayer for Peace in the Middle East: God of mercy and compassion of grace and reconciliation, pour your presence upon all your children in the Middle East: Jews, Muslims, Christians, Palestinians, and Israelis. Let hatred be turned into love, fear to trust, despair to

hope, oppression to freedom, occupation to liberation. That violent encounters may be replaced by loving embraces, and peace and justice maybe experienced by all. Amen.

St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). **Thanks - Donations to date** - Current figure £235,400.00.
Providing compassionate care at the end of life - To address the sensitive issue of compassionate care at the end of life, and in response to the need to inform the faithful of Catholic teaching on this important life issue that affects so many families, the Bishops of Ireland have published the pastoral letter: Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes. You are invited to read this letter and view the accompanying video Through the Valley, which offers personal testimonies by carers and people with terminal illness. The key message of both letter and video asserts that every person possesses inherent, infinite dignity that remains intact regardless of their circumstances. In this context, bishops strongly oppose the Oireachtas Committee's proposal to Government to legislate for assisted suicide and call on support for healthcare workers who uphold the sanctity of life. To read Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes and to watch Through the Valley, visit the following link: https://www.catholicbishops.ie/2024/06/24/bishops-statement-on-end-of-life-care freedom-to-live-fully-until-death-comes/

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine Sharing Good News that reports on stories associated with the Bishops' Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive Sharing Good News, please register your email address on https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/

Errigal Hall Volunteers: For this hospitality to continue in the community, we need new volunteers to come forward and help in this voluntary service to the parish. If you are interested, please contact Melinda Robinson. If enough volunteers come forward a rota can be put in place via a WhatsApp group, so that the same people are not required at each function.

Errigal Hall: Parishioners who borrow items from the hall need to sign for their removal from the hall and when they are returned. The signing book is in the kitchen of the hall.



St. Joseph's Church: Choir Practice will take place each Tuesday at 7pm in the church. New members from Primary 4 up are very welcome. Any queries contact Roisin McIlvar 07841407154.

St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

Maternity Blessing: Expectant mothers are welcome to receive a blessing in any of the sacristies following Mass - and a prayer card for their pregnancy.

Stamps: For the missions can be left at the back of each church.

Synodal Pathway: Find attached the final versions of the National Synthesis for the Church in Ireland, which is the fruit of the recent process of listening and consultation; it is based on the syntheses produced by the 26 dioceses in Ireland, as well as those submitted by religious congregations and other interested groups. Also attach appendix document from survivors of abuse and the Irish Bishops' Conference Cover Letter, which have all been forwarded to the General Secretariat of the Synod of Bishops. Press Release also attached. We are requested to bring the Report to the attention of your parishioners and to share it on your social media outlets. It will be a useful tool as parishes move forward on the synodal journey in the autumn. **The Report is now available on the website of the Synodal Pathway of the Church in Ireland website: www.synod.ie**

Parish Giving

Parish Envelopes: Following previous discussion with the Parish Finance Committee we encourage consideration for those who use envelopes infrequently to consider the use of a standing order, (through this medium you have full control), of the donation at your disposal. **Further information is available from the parish website.**
If you advance the standing order, (it can be processed on-line with your bank), or alternatively bring the completed mandate to your bank. We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. It is with your authorisation that the standing order is either processed weekly or monthly. Also, you can withdraw the mandate at your own discretion. We would appreciate an acknowledgement of this transaction (via the parish email) when it is activated, so that we can have a copy for the parish records. In the information forwarded we will require your address and telephone number.

Several parishioners recently have set up a standing order, however we do not know who these parishioners are because they have not provided an address. We ask please that you follow the instructions above and email the parish to inform us who has authorised the standing order.

We request now that the boxes are delivered, if you have not previously returned or updated a parish Census card, please complete the card in the back of the box and return in the collection envelope. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be signed and returned if you are a taxpayer.
Those who avail of Standing Orders are also asked to complete a Census card and Gift Aid card. These can be collected in each sacristy and returned at your convenience.

Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders:
(Errigal Ballerin: Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) Errigal Development: Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c). (Errigal Glenullin: Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) (Errigal Parish: Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c).
Parish Finance: If you wish to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com or they are available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.
Parish Census: In the recent distribution of collection envelopes, we request that at your earliest convenience you might return the census card with your family details for parish registration. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be updated and signed so that the parish can claim Gift Aid if you are a taxpayer, this does not affect your personal details or taxation. If your tax circumstances change, please inform us, if you are no longer a taxpayer.
Census cards are available in each sacristy, once completed they can be returned in a sealed envelope via the collection box at the back of each church. If you have previously registered, you do not have to do so again, unless your household occupation has changed.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean each church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in each sacristy or alternatively give details to a sacristan.

Mass Cards/Mass Bouquets: Are available for sale at the back of each church please put the money in the candle box.

ACCORD - Counselling: If you need to speak, to an experienced couples and relationships counsellor during this time of unprecedented stress and pressure on family life, please contact 95680151. This is a free helpline service available from 9am - 8pm. Monday to Friday. All calls charged at local rate.

ACCORD DERRY: Virtual Interactive Marriage Preparation Programme (limited to 15 couples per course). Booking now online at www.accordni.com

Radio Maria Ireland: https://www.radiomaria.ie/radio-maria-ireland/ is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station with commercial-free broadcasting of Prayer, Catechesis, Music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O'Kane (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. Tel: 02871 - 362475/07596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org - or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.
Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.
Errigal Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or alternatively it is available from the Parish Office. Live stream of Mass and Services in St. Mary's Church and a Utube streaming in St. Joseph's Church are available online. Parishioners should note that the first three rows of seats are visible in St. Mary's Church.